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Senior Product Manager

Government Digital Service

Apply before 11:45 pm on Sunday 25th October 2026

Government Digital Service

Reference number

486074

Salary

£56,850 - £68,570

£61,620 - 62,170 (London) & £56,850 - £57,400 (Bristol & Manchester) Based on capability. The base salary of this grade is £61,620 for London and £56,850 for other locations. Offers made above this will be made up with a specialist pay allowance

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

GDS - Office of the Chief Technology Officer

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time, Compressed hours

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Bristol, London, Manchester

About the job

Job summary

The Government Digital Service (GDS) is the digital centre of government. We are responsible for setting, leading and delivering the vision for a modern digital government.

Our priorities are to drive a modern digital government, by:

1. joining up public sector services
2. harnessing the power of AI for the public good
3. strengthening and extending our digital and data public infrastructure
4. elevating leadership and investing in talent
5. funding for outcomes and procuring for growth and innovation
6. committing to transparency and driving accountability

We are home to the Incubator for Artificial Intelligence (I.AI), the world-leading GOV.UK and at the forefront of coordinating the UK s geospatial strategy and activity. We lead the Government Digital and Data function and champion the work of digital teams across government.

We re part of the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (DSIT) and employ more than 1,000 people all over the UK, with hubs in Manchester, London and Bristol.

The Government Digital Service is where talent translates into impact. From your first day, you ll be working with some of the world s most highly-skilled digital professionals, all contributing their knowledge to make change on a national scale.

Join us for rewarding work that makes a difference across the UK. You'll solve some of the nation s highest-priority digital challenges, helping millions of people access services they need.

Job description

Within the Office of the Chief Technology Officer (OCTO), you will act as a Senior Product Manager, setting the vision, strategy and roadmap for products and initiatives that support government's digital transformation ambitions.

OCTO sits within the Digital Transformation Group and is responsible for enabling change and growth across the public sector s digital estate. In this role, you will work across departmental and organisational boundaries to understand user and stakeholder needs, align priorities and deliver products, services and capabilities that drive measurable improvements across government.

We re looking for an experienced product manager who can lead a complex, high-risk or sensitive product, or a group of related products, through the full product life cycle. You will be comfortable setting direction, making evidence-based decisions and working across organisational boundaries to deliver valuable outcomes for users and government.

As a Senior Product Manager, you will:

- set the vision, strategy and roadmap for products and initiatives that support OCTO's priorities
- lead multidisciplinary teams to deliver products and services that solve cross-government challenges
- use evidence, insight and user needs to prioritise work and guide product decisions
- collaborate across cross-functional teams to turn strategic priorities into measurable outcomes
- build stakeholder alignment and influence decision-making across government
- develop business cases, roadmaps and recommendations for senior leaders
- measure outcomes and use data to drive continuous improvement
- champion product management and user-centred ways of working across OCTO
- make evidence-based prioritisation and investment decisions, balancing user needs, policy intent, technical constraints, delivery risks and value for money

Person specification

We re interested in people who have experience of:

- Product management: defining product vision, strategy and prioritised roadmaps to deliver measurable outcomes
- Strategic ownership: aligning product direction with user needs, organisational priorities and government objectives
- User-centred product development: using user research and data to inform decisions and ensure services are inclusive and accessible
- Innovation and user-focused problem solving: applying creative and strategic thinking to identify opportunities, challenge assumptions and

develop effective solutions that meet end user needs and improve outcomes

Managing product outcomes: defining success measures and using evidence to evaluate performance and drive improvement

Product leadership: leading multidisciplinary teams, influencing stakeholders and championing product-led ways of working

Stakeholder relationship management: building consensus, influencing decisions and managing competing priorities across organisational boundaries

Agile and Lean practices: applying appropriate delivery approaches to maximise learning, value and delivery outcomes

Life cycle management: managing products through discovery, delivery, continuous improvement and retirement

Creating value for money: balancing user needs, cost and benefits to inform investment and prioritisation decisions

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £56,850, Government Digital Service contributes £16,469 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides (opens in a new window).

There are many benefits of working at GDS, including:

flexible hybrid working with flexi-time and the option to work part-time or condensed hours

a Civil Service Pension with an average employer contribution of 28.97%

25 days of annual leave, increasing by a day each year up to a maximum of 30 days

an extra day off for the King s birthday

an in-year bonus scheme to recognise high performance

career progression and coaching, including a training budget for personal development

a focus on wellbeing with access to an employee assistance programme

- job satisfaction from making government services easier to use and more inclusive for people across the UK
- advances on pay, including for travel season tickets
- death in service benefits
- cycle to work scheme and facilities
- access to an employee discounts scheme
- 10 learning days per year
- volunteering opportunities (5 special leave days per year)
- access to a suite of learning activities through Civil Service learning

Any move to Government Digital Service from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk

Office attendance
The Department operates a discretionary hybrid working policy, which provides for a combination of working hours from your place of work and from your home in the UK. The current expectation for staff is to attend the office or non-home based location for 40-60% of the time over the accounting period.
DSIT does not normally offer full home working (i.e. working at home); but we do offer a variety of flexible working options (including occasionally working from home).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and

internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

The standard selection process for roles at GDS consists of:

- a simple application screening process - We only ask for a CV and to answer 2 application Questions.
- a 60 minute video interview which will feature a scenario based presentation task. Details of the task will be shared with invited candidates prior to the interview

Depending on how many applications we get, there might also be an extra stage before the video interview, for example a phone interview or a technical exercise.

In the event we receive a high volume of applications, we will conduct the initial sift against the lead criteria which is:

- Describe a time when you were responsible for delivering a product or service that required agreement and adoption across multiple government teams, departments, or organisations. How did you build alignment, manage differing priorities, and influence stakeholders where you had no direct authority?

In the Civil Service, we use Success Profiles to evaluate your skills and ability. This gives us the best possible chance of finding the right person for the job, increases performance and improves diversity and inclusivity. We ll be assessing your technical abilities, skills, experience and behaviours that are relevant to this role.

For this role we ll be assessing you against the following Civil Service Behaviours:

- seeing the bigger picture
- leadership
- communicating and influencing

We ll also be assessing your experience and specialist technical skills against the following skills defined in the Government Digital and Data Capability Framework for the Senior Product Manager role:

- Product management
- Managing product outcomes
- Stakeholder relationship management
- Strategic ownership

Recruitment Timeline

Sift completion: 2/11/2026

Panel interviews: Starting from 9/11/2026

Candidates that do not pass the interview but have demonstrated an acceptable standard may be considered for similar roles at a lower grade.

A reserve list will be held for a period of 12 months, from which further appointments can be made.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan and the Civil Service D&I Strategy.

This role will Require SC Clearance - more details are available via the application link

Sponsorship

DSIT cannot offer Visa sponsorship to candidates through this campaign. DSIT holds a Visa sponsorship licence but this can only be used for certain roles and this campaign does not qualify.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is security check (opens in a new window).

See our vetting charter (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)
- individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020
- Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. Read more about prison leaver recruitment (opens in new window).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact gds-complaints@dsit.gov.uk in the first instance.

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive you can contact the Civil Service Commission by email: info@csc.gov.uk Or in writing: Civil Service Commission, Room G/8 1 Horse Guards Road, London, SW1A 2HQ.

Civil Service Commission

disability confident EMPLOYER